

Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Livestock at Processing Establishments

AWTG 26-01 noted further updates from the cross-jurisdictional working group, led by Queensland, which is considering options to progress the development of the processing standards.

Pig Welfare

AWTG discussed engagement with Australian Pork Limited on their industry project to improve the welfare of pigs.

Virtual Fencing Technology

New South Wales, Victoria and South Australia provided an update on their regulatory decisions to permit the use of virtual fencing for cattle. AWTG discussed the finalisation of the virtual fencing project.

Implementation of the Australian Animal Welfare Standards and Guidelines for Poultry into state and territory legislation

AWTG discussed updating state and territory senior officials on progress to implement the poultry standards into state and territory legislation.

Renewed Australian Animal Welfare Strategy (AAWS)

AWTG noted an update from the Commonwealth on the stakeholder engagement activities undertaken in late 2025 and early 2026 for the development of the Livestock and Production and Aquatic Animals chapters of the Australian Animal Welfare Strategy. AWTG were notified of next steps to develop chapter working drafts, with stakeholder engagement to continue.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/animal/welfare/awtg/communique-february-2026>